

# Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

## Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

## Customer Details

Name: Mrs Tazeen Rehman

Address: Flat 2 469 Gander Green Lane North Cheam SM3 9RA

## Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am a local resident writing in wholehearted support of application DM2025/01591. In my view this proposal addresses a real need and will bring positive change to a site that currently sits empty and unused.

The link between community participation and better health outcomes is not disputed. What is often lacking is the local infrastructure to make participation possible. This proposal provides that infrastructure in an area where it is currently missing.

I would also note that this proposal will provide a facility that all residents can use, with a programme of activities designed to be accessible and welcoming to people of all backgrounds and ages. The Belmont area currently has very limited community space.

The noise assessment addresses the concerns that have been raised by objectors and finds them unsupported. The building fabric will contain sound effectively, the operating hours are restricted, and the predicted noise at neighbouring properties is below existing background levels.

The applicant has specifically timetabled Friday prayer changeover to avoid the school-run period. The evidence shows this has been done successfully, with a clear gap of over two hours between the two activities.

The proposed use is clearly policy-supported, the technical evidence is thorough, and the community benefit is substantial. I trust that the Council will assess this application on its planning merits.

Furthermore, this part of the borough is underserved when it comes to community facilities. The application establishes a clear need, and the proposed mix of faith and community uses means the benefits extend well beyond any single group.

It is also worth mentioning that the NPPF requires authorities to plan positively for these uses. Sutton's own Local Plan identifies community centres and places of worship as essential social infrastructure under Policy 33. This proposal is exactly what those policies were written to support.

I have read the Transport Statement and the parking evidence is convincing. A survey during the peak Friday prayer period found on-street parking at less than 50% capacity in the surrounding area. The worst-case modelling still leaves 66 spaces available and stays well under the 85% parking stress threshold.

I think this application deserves approval and I respectfully ask the Council to grant planning permission for DM2025/01591.